

5 Age of Empires II

Platforms: Windows, Mac OS, PS2
Release Year: 1999

Age of Empires II may not be considered a strategy game for purists but it was, nonetheless, the game that made the strategy genre much less intimidating to gamers. And it was in its second installment, based in the Middle Ages, that AOE truly shone thanks to refined mechanics and the presence of a large number of different civilizations, all of whom allowed for different styles of play. Plus, frantic matches with your friends over LAN, unbeatable!



6 Grand Theft Auto: Vice City

Platforms: Windows, PS2, PS3, Xbox, OS X, Android, iOS
Release Year: 2002

It would be so easy to justify Vice City's inclusion in this list by merely pointing towards its soundtrack but we won't do that. Even though it had music from Foreigner, Michael Jackson, INXS, Iron Maiden and Blondie, we won't mention it! Shocking, subversive humour, a sprawling open city and complete freedom to play the game the way you chose was also a draw. It was the base for the refined experiences of San Andreas, GTA IV and GTA V.



7 The Last of Us

Platforms: PS3, PS4 (Remastered edition)
Release Year: 2013

It's always tough for a game released on a single platform to contend for the title of a 'classic' and especially a 'modern classic' but we have no qualms about putting The Last of Us in this list. The reason why it's a must-play game is because of the mature way it tells its story, its naturalistic take on characters and its beautiful and stark environments, all of which were clearly influenced by literary giants such as Stephen King and Cormac McCarthy and movies such as Children of Men and I Am Legend.



8 Forza Motorsport 3

Platforms: Xbox 360
Release Year: 2009

Widely considered to be the best racing game ever released, Forza Motorsport 3 is an obvious choice. Despite not being the best looking game, Forza scores high thanks to a rich career mode, amazingly fun multiplayer and gameplay that could be tuned to suit the needs of both casual gamers and hardcore simulation fans.



9 Resident Evil 4

Platforms: Windows, PS2, PS3, Xbox 360, Wii, GameCube, iOS
Release Year: 2005

Any discussion on survival horror games is incomplete without the mention of Resident Evil 4. When released Resident Evil 4 was praised all around for its character and level design, methodical gameplay that served to heighten tension and scares and an innovative over the shoulder camera that helped gamers see more of the action. Resident Evil 4 was ultimately responsible (along with Silent Hill 2) for a resurgence in action oriented survival horror games.



10 The Legend of Zelda: Ocarina of Time

Platforms: Nintendo 64, Nintendo GameCube, Wii
Release Year: 1998

Ever wondered why The Legend of Zelda series has such a passionate fan following? Well, play the Ocarina of Time and you'll find out. The game has near perfect level design and gameplay mechanics that marries action with RPG elements. Add to that, a great story and a lovable protagonist in Link all of which makes this game a must play for everyone.



11 Metal Gear Solid 4: Guns of the Patriots

Platform: PS3
Release Year: 2008

Fans of movies that offer over the top spectacles will love MGS 4 and they did, with over five million copies sold in a year making it the best selling PS3 title until Gran Turismo 5 broke that record. While maintaining traditional MGS gameplay elements such as stealth, melee combat and gunplay, MGS 4 also tried to emulate battle stress with its Psyche Meter that was affected by temperature and enemy actions, among other things. This is the best game in the Metal Gear series.



12 Super Mario Galaxy 2

Platform: Wii
Release Year: 2010

Super Mario Galaxy 2 is not just one of the greatest games ever released but it's also probably the best platformer ever released. It's also the perfect example of why violence, gore and a story that takes itself way too seriously aren't mandatory to make a great game. SMG 2 pops with colour, fascinating characters and innovative gameplay that requires you to think differently, but the stars of the show are the amazing variety of different planets that you can visit. Even if your gaming diet consists only of Halo, Gears of War and Call of Duty, play Super Mario Galaxy 2.



13 Civilization V

Platforms: Windows, OS X
Release Year: 2010

How do you release a new game in a series that has been alive since 1991 and whose last installment was widely considered to be the best ever? Well, you do whatever Firaxis did when they launched Civilization V. It was another step towards perfection. In fact, we would argue that Civ V is the best game in the series and has been improved by its two expansions. So, go ahead and install Civ V but don't blame us for your inevitable addiction.

